and reach out to the larger society.'

Every Saturday, Sunday and other holidays went into social work, she says. 'Which is why I have continued to nurture it even today. It has to come from within you.' Be it prison reforms, crime, law or drug abuse treatment centres, Bedi pursued her passion. Her latest initiative is as a judge for the Lead India* campaign. 'India has always given social leaders who never got print space as compared to political leaders. What Lead India is doing is identifying genuine, worthwhile social leaders and giving them visibility.'

(The Times of India, 7 January 2008)

I could set up the e-portal with the help of a team of four friends, namely, Achal Paul, Arvind Verma, Naveen Varshneya and Ms Maldeep Sidhu, all professionals from various fields such as science and technology, mass communication and law. The service is responding to complaints from all over the country, besides providing internships to law students. It has a full-time webmaster, Anup Sinha, plus an administrator, a retired cop from Uttar Pradesh, K. K. Gautam, and a voluntary legal adviser in Advocate Raj Kumar Yadav.

The procedure for lodging a report on www.saferindia.com is as follows: on receipt of an e-complaint the webmaster forwards the matter to the appropriate police headquarters, or other appropriate authorities, with a copy marked to the sender. Now the sender is expected to take a printout of the complaint and follow up with the concerned authorities to ask for the progress made in the matter. Now, the police cannot say that there is no complaint on record, since it would have reached the relevant police headquarters by email.

As of date, we have attended to thousands of such complaints. And matters have moved forward in many cases. This claim is based on the reports of the interns who have been associated with this project from time to time. The feedback I received from a co-passenger (who happened to be a school principal) on a flight brought out the impact of the e-project. She told me one of her teachers came to her with the grouse that the police refused to register her complaint. She then advised the teacher to go back to the police and tell them that she would send an email to www.saferindia.com in case they again refused to register her complaint. She said the police promptly complied with her request.

Since its launch in January 2008, the Safer India Movement has enrolled hundreds of volunteers from different parts of the country and has opened hubs in the major cities around the capital. A number of interns from law schools have carried out research on this project. Some of their reports have been posted on the website.

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Being a master of my time, I have now started to accept more invitations within India and overseas. These invitations have been for speaking engagements and award-receiving and award-giving ceremonies, which I could not attend earlier, due to my duty priorities. Such occasions have provided increased support to my two NGOs: Navjyoti and India Vision Foundation.

I am now even more accessible to the media on a variety of issues. I write more often for newspapers and magazines. I conduct a weekly programme called 'Top Cat' on Radio Meow of the *India Today* group, a first-of-its-kind-channel for women. Most of all, I am now closer to all my ongoing projects: in prisons, in villages and in slums, which benefit over 12,000 people each day. There are nearly 230 staff members comprising teachers, doctors, counsellors, managers, supervisors